

Commander's Manual

"The Ledger remembers each shot fired, each soldier
felled, each squad wiped. For each loss you make,
someone else makes a profit."
- Elen Shturman, 4 Platinum Stars Commander



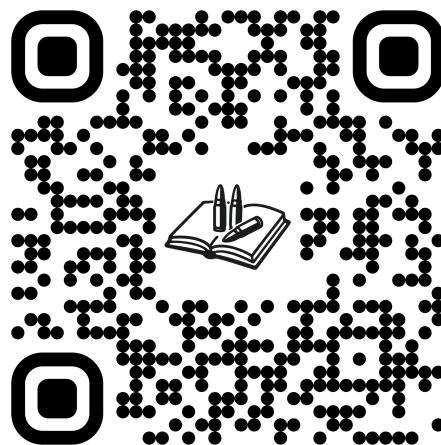
This book and the game it explains are still in development.
Please be patient with any imbalances, missing info, or edge cases that might exist.

It's advised that you accompany your game with someone who has some knowledge of Lead Ledger and who can log the game, so that we can have more info from playtesters

During play, if any questions arise, feel free to ask them to the most experienced person. If needed, the Discord server is always open for questions.

Thank you for helping with the development of Lead Ledger.

Lead Ledger Discord:



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“Organization is the basis of every winning strategy.”
– Introduction to Strategy, page 26

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Introduction

“Tactics and Strategy tests are standard-issue for all who wish to become commanders.”
– Introduction to the Ledger I, page 8

Welcome to the standard issue Commander’s Manual for Lead Ledger. Remember to keep it safe from bullets, grenades, tank shells, and coffee stains.

This manual contains all the information a beginner or veteran commander may need while on the battlefield – or at the table.

Before we continue, make sure this is the most up-to-date version of this manual, so you can have the best experience.

Lead Ledger is a tabletop war game in which players command armies against each other, in an ever-lasting conquest of the New World. Hired commanders, players will pick your fighters from several mercenary groups, use a mixture of careful positioning, thought-out tactics, and a bit of luck to defeat their opponents, and lay claim to resource-rich areas in the name of capitalism.

Despite this, Lead Ledger is a game, and as such, an enjoyable experience is at its core for both players. So remember to be polite to your opponent, since your soldiers will not have that luxury.

If during a game any questions arise, feel free to discuss with your opponent, and drop by the Lead Ledger Discord server (QR code at the back of the cover), where we can answer all doubts you may have. As a bonus, and by doing so, you are contributing to the development of this game. Thank you!

Equipment Required

To play Lead Ledger, you need:

- This book;
- The hex map (8 tiles per side);
- A twelve-sided dice (d12);
- Markers, tokens, or counters for Health and Control (named “pips”).

This is a multiplayer game for 2 players. More can play, but it’s out of the current scope of the project. Each player needs an army.

Core Concepts

“Knowing the difference between the bullet and the casing is basic knowledge for ballistics – and one that movie directors seem to miss”
– Introduction to Ballistics, page 4

This section introduces several terms that you will find throughout this manual and many other publications. Knowing these is the basis of any knowledge of Lead Ledger.

Armies

Each player commands an army of units from up to 3 regiments. Your army size is determined beforehand and is the same for both players.

Regiments

A regiment is a group of similarly themed units. These can have a Regiment Rule that affects units from that regiment, the whole army, or the whole map. You can have up to 3 regiments in an army.

Units

A unit is a representation of a squad of infantry, vehicle, or tank as a model. Each unit belongs to a regiment and has an associated Datasheet. Units from the same army are allies, while units from different armies are enemies.

Datasheets

Each unit's datasheet contains all the necessary information: its stats, weapons, keywords, tags, and rules. You will need the datasheets of all units in your army, and the datasheet information is public for both players.

Keywords and Tags

A keyword is a larger rule abbreviated into a word or short expression (ex: Assault, Precision), while a tag serves to distinguish units by their types (ex: Infantry, Vehicle). Keywords apply to both weapons and units, while tags apply to units only.

Weapons

Usually carried by units and showcased in their datasheets, each weapon has its own stat line. A weapon's type is defined in its name, beside its caliber.

Maps

A game of Lead Ledger is played on a hexagonal map, with an 8-tile side. Most of your units will be on the map, with the rest in reserves.

Tiles

A tile is a subsection of the map and the measurement of every range in the game. Each tile is subdivided into 6 triangles (slots), which units can occupy. Tiles can have Buildings on them, with an associated Health. Tiles with enemy units on them are Enemy Tiles.

Arcs

From any Tile, there are 6 Arcs, spanning 60° each, defined easily by each adjacent tile. If a Tile is partially within those 60°, it is within that Arc. A Tile can be in more than one Arc.

Buildings

A tile can have a Building on it, represented by a border and some already occupied slots. Each building has a certain amount of health, which can be depleted by shots from units. Some buildings contribute to scoring and are called Objective Buildings.

Distances

Distances are measured in tiles, with the most direct path possible. Starts at 0 for the origin tile.

Visibility

Unit A is visible to Unit B if it's possible to draw an uninterrupted line between the center of A's main slot (the centermost triangle) and any part of B's model. Enemy units block the line of sight, while allied units don't.

Contract Your Army

"A mercenary army only functions as long as the money is flowing. Commanders are often as much economists and managers as they are generals."
- Military Economics, page 34

In this section, you will find the information you need when building a Lead Ledger army. Make sure you have the most up-to-date version of the units pool.

Unit costs are based on two metrics: Manpower and Materials. Each battle size has a limit for each of the costs. The limits for contracting and deployment are different. You can always contract more units than you can deploy, and the units that are or are not deployed are only determined during a game. Use these extra points to counter-play your opponent's deployment.

To build an army, follow the steps below:

Select Army Size

Choose an army size from below. This will not only limit your costs but also change the number of turns in a game, making it longer.

Costs are shown as MP/Mat.

Skirmish

Contract: 150/300
Deployment: 100/200
Duration: 60 turns
Map size: 13 tiles

Engagement

Contract: 225/450
Deployment: 150/300
Duration: 100 turns
Map size: 13 tiles

Conquest

Contract: 300/600
Deployment: 200/400
Duration: 150 turns
Map size: 15 tiles

Dominion

Contract: 450/900
Deployment: 300/600
Duration: 220 turns
Map size: 17 tiles

Select Regiments

From the available regiments, choose up to 3 to make up your army. You can change these as you build it, but the final iteration must not have more than 3 regiments.

Each Regiment gives you access to its units, its Regiment Ability and its Scheme. You cannot have units in your army from outside the 3 chosen regiments.

Select Units

From the chosen regiments, choose any number of units to contract to your army. You can add units only if:

- It's from one of the chosen regiments
- Its costs would not make you breach any of the Contracting Costs' limits
- You don't already have three units equal to the new one, or six units if that unit has the Fodder tag.

Starting A Battle

“A house is never built from the roof, and those who dream only of the final blow seldom land the first. A strong opening is better than mastering a checkmate that never comes.”
– Engagement & Positioning, page 89

This section contains the information for starting a battle. All the steps and interactions each player takes.

Presentation

Both players reveal their full armies, Datasheets, and associated rules

Set Player Order

Randomly choose a player.

That player decides whether to take the first or second turn.

Mission & Schemes

Players alternate banning missions until one remains; that mission is the “active mission”.

Then, players choose a Scheme from their available list in turn order.

Map Setup

Set up the battlefield according to mission instructions, such as Objective Buildings and terrain.

Deploy Armies

Starting with the first player, deploy one Unit or Structure at a time. The total cost of deployed units from each player cannot exceed the Deployment Limit.

The first deployment must be adjacent to your map edge; subsequent deployments must be adjacent to deployed tiles, up to 3 tiles from the edge, or also be adjacent to your map edge.

At any point before hitting the deployment limit, any player can choose not to deploy more units. If this happens, the other player can continue to deploy units without taking turns, stopping whenever they want.

Reserves

If any player who could still deploy units chose not to, players start placing units into their Reserves following the same timing as normal Deployment. The sum of the costs of the units deployed and in reserves cannot exceed the Deployment Limit.

Any units not deployed or in reserves are Out Of Battle.

Starting Actions

Each player performs any “Before the Battle” actions in turn order.

Then the Battle Phase begins, starting with the first player.

Turns, Cycles and Scoring

“As the clock of battle stretches on, commanders tally their victories and defeats, aiming to better adapt to the ever-changing role they must play.”
– Evan Jenkins, 5 Platinum Stars Commander

The Battle Phase of a Lead Ledger game is split into turns, but those turns are joined in Cycles. Each Cycle is 10 turns, 5 from each player, and many things are counted, replenished, or given at the beginning or end of each Cycle. One player takes the odd turns, and the other takes the even turns.

Players' Turns

Beginning Phase > Primary Phase > Secondary Phase > Ending Phase
Action Phase

Cycles

Beginning of Cycle > Turns > Scoring > End of Cycle

Scoring

At the end of each Cycle, each commander tallies the number of pips of their color in Objective Buildings and puts the result on the Scoreboard.

Win Condition: Annihilation

If all units from a player's army are destroyed or not deployed, that player immediately loses the game.

Win Condition: Conquest

At the end of the game, the player with the most points on the Scoreboard wins.

Command Points

At the beginning of each Cycle, each player receives 1 Command Point (CP). Each player can store up to 5 CP.

Action Phase & Orders

"From calculated executions to desperate attempts, your story is written solely on the battlefield, nowhere else."

– Evan Jenkins, 5 Platinum Stars Commander

The Action Phase is where each player makes their actions with their units. It's the proper game, if you will.

At the beginning of their turn, the active player gets a Primary and Secondary Order. They can spend these however they want, with restrictions based on the action type chosen.

Primary Orders are made during the Primary Phase and Secondary Action during the Secondary Phase. Orders are made as Actions, so they can only be made when there are no abilities or actions waiting to the resolve (on the Stack)

Each unit's weapon cannot be used twice during the same turn. Each unit cannot move itself twice on the same turn (but can be moved by external sources).

Primary Orders

Advance

Move a unit up to its M stat

Embark

Embark a unit into a transport, by moving up to 1

Disembark

Disembark a unit from a transport, and move up to 1

Salvo

Shoot up to all of a unit's weapons.

Conquer

Capture a building by turning its Pips to your color. When turning neutral pips this way, turn twice that many pips.

Overwatch

Choose a weapon and an arc that the unit can shoot to. The unit goes into Focus. When an enemy enters, moves, or exits this unit's range within the chosen arc, it may shoot the enemy immediately.

Secondary Orders

Relocate

Move a unit 1. Cannot be used by units with 1 or less M, or units that have already moved this turn.

Consolidate

Choose an allied unit. Move up to 2 units into that unit's tile. Those units can only move 1.

Occupy

Capture a building by turning its Pips to your color. Cannot be used by units that have already captured this turn

Fire

Shoot a single weapon. This shot is at most a 9+ or 4- if you are rolling up or down, respectively. Cannot be used by units that have already shot or moved this turn.

Commands

“Sometimes, the soldiers need a bit more guidance than a simple 'do this', be it information, directions, or just a little encouragement.”

– Elen Shturman, 4 Platinum Stars Commander

At the beginning of each Cycle, each player gets 1 Command Point (CP) and can store up to 4, which can be used for several Commands: stronger actions and decisions that can change the battlefield.

Generic Commands

Name	Costs	When	Targets	Effects
Runover	1 CP	After an allied M or H vehicle has Advanced.	That allied M or H vehicle; Enemy infantry in the same tile.	The enemy suffers a number of 10+ Wounds equal to the ally's Health, suffering 2 more if the ally is Heavy and 2 less for each Armor Size of the enemy above N. This Command cannot deal more than 4 damage.
Sabotage	1 CP, 1 Minor Action	As a Minor Action	Allied infantry unit; Enemy vehicle unit in the same tile	The enemy suffers a number of 9+ Mortal Wounds equal to the ally's Health. This Command always deals at least 1 damage
Emergency Reload	1 CP	Any time on your turn	Allied unit with at least one Loading Weapon	Immediately restore all Ammo to all Loading Weapons equipped by that unit.
Commander's Luck	1 CP	After you make a Penetration Check, Damage Check, or Evasion Check for an allied unit.	That allied unit.	Re-roll that roll or check
Prepared shot	1 CP	At the end of your turn.	An allied unit.	That unit cannot move next turn. That unit's Weapons gain Precision in your next turn.

Movement

“Historically, mobility has been a massive part of many war strategies. How your units move dictates where they are and can be, which in turn dictates where they can shoot and protect.”
– Wheels and Tracks, page 16

Moving a unit can have several restrictions, highlighted in this section.

When moving a unit, do the number of Movement Sub-Actions (MSA for short) mentioned on the action or ability description.

An MSA can have different restrictions depending on unit type and other factors. An MSA is legal if it observes its restrictions and, at the end of its resolution, the unit does not overlap with any other unit.

Movement Types

Freedom of Movement (FM)

For units with Freedom of Movement, each MSA is the simple action of moving the unit from its current slot to any other slot in its current tile or any adjacent tiles.

Directional Movement (DM)

For units with Directional Movement, each MSA is a combination in any order of a forward and a turn. Any of these can be skipped to get a single forward or a single turn.

A forward is moving the unit from its current tile to the tile directly in front, onto the same slots. If a unit has more than one front, it can move to either tile.

A turn is spinning the unit a single slot within its tile.

Unit Movement by Types

Infantry

Infantry has Freedom of Movement with no additional restrictions.

Vehicles

Vehicles have Directional Movement.

When moving a Heavy Vehicle, a forward cannot be performed after a turn within the same MSA.

Transports

Transports are special units that can carry at least one Infantry unit inside. Infantry can enter or exit a Transport with the Embark and Disembark Major actions.

While an Infantry unit is inside a Transport, it cannot be targeted by any shots, including shots with Blast. When the transport is damaged, the unit inside suffers a 10+ Wound.

Shooting & Damaging

"Ledger contracts seldom end in anything other than blood."
-Aleksy Fallat, Odrak Arms Training Officer

Shots and Wounds are the main damage outputs of Lead Ledger. While simple in their execution, each bullet fired works differently against each type of armor.

Damage Types

Shot

Fired by most weapons. Shots can miss and must penetrate armor to deal damage. This type uses a Penetration Check, not a damage check.

Precise Shot

Made by weapons with Precision. Precise Shots always hit; no Evasion Check is made. They still require a Penetration Check.

Wound

Usually caused by abilities. Wounds use a variable Damage Check listed in the ability. Wounds can be evaded. Written as "N± Wounds", where N± is the Check Objective.

Mortal Wounds

Certain abilities deal Mortal Wounds. These cannot be evaded, so no Evasion Check is made. Written as "N± Mortal Wounds", where N± is the Check Objective.

Reading Shots

Shots and Wounds often use abbreviations to shorten rules and requirements.

- Weapon penetration: Every weapon has a penetration value for each armor size. This value sets the Penetration Check Objective for the Shot.
- Armor: The armor size of a unit. Can be Unarmored, Light, Medium, or Heavy.
- Ammo type: The type of Ammo shot. Usually indicated in the weapon's name, otherwise it's ST by default. Can be ST, AC, HESH, HEAT, T-HEAT (Tandem), APFSDS, HER, or ATGM.
- Extra Armor: Extra characteristics of the Armor, which are more or less impactful depending on the type of weapon shot. These can modify the roll, based on the Extra Armors Table, but are ignored when Rolling Down.
- AP: Modifiers applied to Shots. These can be buffs or debuffs, and can be applied to singular shots, all shots from a weapon, or all shots from a unit.

These are paired: Weapon Penetrations interact with the Armor Size, while Ammo Types interact with Extra Armors.

Resolving Damage

Resolve any damage using the steps below:

1. Targeting: For Shots only. Choose an enemy Unit within the weapons Range and within Line of Sight. That unit becomes the Target
2. Evasion: If applicable, the enemy makes an Evasion Check. On a fail, the damage hits. Otherwise, it misses.
3. Check:
 - For Shots, make a Penetration Check, with the check's objective given by the weapon's penetration against the target's Armor Size, adding all AP modifiers (such as those from the Extra Armors Table).
 - For Wounds, make a check with the objective given in the Wound description.
 - On a fail, the attack does not penetrate or wound. Otherwise, the target is damaged.
4. Health: If the damage hits and damages the unit, it loses 1 Health.

Extra Armors

Ammo Type → Armor Type ↓	ST	AC	HESH	HEAT	T-HEAT	APFSDS	HER	ATGM
Sloped	○	●	○	○	○	○	○	○
Composite	○	●	○	○	○	○	●	○
ERA	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	○
NERA	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	○
Spaced	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Slat	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	○
APS	○	○	○	●	○	○	●	●

Ignore if rolling down: ○/●

Sloped, Composite, NERA, Spaced, Slat: -2/4 AP

ERA: -4/8 AP. 2 uses per battle

APS: 2/4 dodge. Not ignored when Rolling Down.

Fortifications

“From abandoned civilian buildings to active military HQs, these mark the target of every campaign. As such, their conquest and securement are vital.”
– Objectives, Infrastructure & Conquest, page 27

Across the battlefield, you will find several Fortifications. These can be placed by the mission (such as objectives or simply terrain), by players, or by units.

Each fortification occupies at least one tile. Within the fortification, some slots may be occupied by its Health, shown in the number of pips on it. These pips also symbolize the control of this fortification by their color.

Fortification Health

A fortification's health physically occupies some slot within its tile, with each slot starting with at most 3 health. As the fortification is destroyed, it also clears slots from its tile, opening space for more and larger units.

When damaging a fortification, don't roll for penetration. Instead, remove that amount of health pips from the fortification. Pips are removed one at a time and must be removed from the most common color. In case of a tie, remove pips from the following priority: Neutral > Enemy > Ally. Enemy units inside suffer a number of 10+ Wounds equal to the damage dealt.

Health Checks

When a fortification has less health than the sum of the health of the units inside, each unit inside can shoot another until there are no enemy units inside or the sum of the health of units inside is at most equal to the fortification's health.

Shot priority starts from the unit with the least Health. In case of a tie, the tied unit of the player that damaged the fortification starts.

Visibility and Movement

When entering a fortification, a unit ends its movement, independently of how much it could still move.

A unit inside a fortification can only be targeted by shots at range 0, but can shoot any unit outside the fortification. Units inside fortifications are visible to units outside, but fortifications block Line of Sight.

Dice & Rolling

"Luck is not an affordable liability on the battlefield, but one we must face nonetheless. A correct strategy can minimize it. As such, the best commanders are often on the unluckier side."
– Elen Shturman, 4 Platinum Stars Commander

Many aspects of Lead Ledger are decided by rolling dice.

If the dice is not mentioned when asking for a roll, the dice to use is a D12. Some rules may refer to 2D12, 3D12, and so on. This means rolling that many D12 and adding the results. An "unmodified roll" is the value of the roll before any modifiers are applied to it (usually the value on the dice itself, or the sum of them).

All rolls are resolved in the following order:

1. Roll the given dice. The result is the "unmodified roll"
2. If you can and want to, you may re-roll the allowed rolls. These replace your original rolls.
3. Add all modifiers you may have that affect the roll. This is the final result of your roll.

Checks

The most common way to roll dice is by making a check. These have an associated dice (usually a d12) and an objective. This target is a number followed by a "+" or a "-" symbol, indicating more or less than the number, respectively.

A check can have various possible objectives with differing effects or modifiers. You choose which one to take, and cannot change mid-way.

A check is passed or a success if the result matches the criteria, or a failure if the result does not match the criteria.

A check can also have "degrees of success", with the various possible outcomes linked to a range of results (e.g, 4-7)

Common Checks

Damage Check

A simple check with the objective given by the calling effect. On a fail, the affected unit is dealt 1 damage (losing 1 Health).

Penetration Check

Similar to a Damage Check, but given by the weapon and armor. Additionally, armor effects are used only for this check.

Evasion Check

The check's objective is given by the unit's Dodge minus the enemy unit's Accuracy, rolling down. On a success, the shot/damage/ability misses.

Re-rolls

Some abilities allow you to re-roll dice. This means you get to attempt a second roll of those dice. You can never re-roll a dice more than once, and all re-rolls are made at the same time. Conditional re-rolls take the value of the unmodified roll for their trigger.

If you roll more than one dice as part of the same roll, you cannot re-roll only part of the dice. Either reroll all or none.

Multiple Rolls

When rolling dice, it's important to know what you are rolling for and how to roll them.

You can roll for several checks or rules at the same time, provided they are equal in requirements and effects (e.g., two shots from the same unit and weapon to the same target). These rolls are still individual rolls that were simply made at the same time for ease-of-use, but could also be made individually, one at a time.

However, if a rule asks for 2D12, those dice are part of the same roll and cannot, for example, be re-rolled individually.

Effects

“The ever-changing battlefield rewards those eager to learn. Listen to your troops, and spy on the enemy, for all their information is invaluable.”
– Battlefield Intelligence, page 63

Abilities from various sources create temporary or lingering effects. These effects can be replacements of rules, checks, or additional buffs or debuffs.

Effect priorities

- If an ability from whatever source directly contradicts any Core Rules, the ability takes precedence. This ability overrides only the rule that applies to the situation.
- If an effect allows or directs something to happen, and another effect states that it can't happen, the can't takes precedence. This precedence is only applicable if these are two effects from sources other than the Core Rules.

Replacement Effects

Some effects or abilities replace some events altogether. These are usually indicated by an “instead” or “skip”. The replaced events do not happen. As such, anything that could trigger from those events also does not trigger. If an event is skipped, it is simply replaced with nothing. A replacement effect cannot trigger itself, or from other replacement effects that have triggered from it.

Datasheets

1. Unit Name
2. Description and Role
3. MACH stats: Movement, Armor Size, Control, Health
4. Contracting Costs
5. Unit Tags
6. Unit Size
7. Weapon Caliber & Type (HEAT)
8. Weapon Range
9. Penetration against each Armor Size
10. Weapon Keywords
11. Unit Abilities

M14 Puma

1. Assault Light Tank

2.

M	A	C	H
3	L	0	3

3.

MP	Mat
15	55

4. **Tags:** *Vehicle, Light Tank*

5.

6. 

7. **Weaponry:**

Name	R	N	L	M	H	F	Keywords
105mm Attack HEAT	2	NA	8-	4+	9+	NA	Assault

8.

9.

10.

11. **Abilities:** None